

sentient right now, and the internet hive mind may be experimenting on us as we speak. Poking and prodding us with information to see how we react, and camouflaged as an algorithm created by humans.

And that's the really scary part, for me. Given that we're already all addicted to technology, and the addiction is getting worse, are we being realistic at all when we imagine robot uprisings and us being the slave owners... when in fact we could already be slaves of the technology hive mind!

WHAT'S NEXT?

Although I love to do a little fear-mongering (like in the last paragraph), I think because we have built our machines to mimic us, we are essentially working towards a cyborg future that will make us more human, not less. We will have enhanced abilities in all of the ways we have abilities already. If it's art, we will be able to use cyborg abilities to make art that we can't even imagine right now. The same goes for mental abilities, physical abili-

ties... music, movies, entertainment, research... anything we partake in!

I also don't think we will ever get human-like AI, because although we use technology to mimic humans, it might not be the native state that technology gravitates towards. Think of it as forcing a ballerina to play football (I have World Cup fever). Because we love football, we'd be able to get a ballerina to play football with us, and we'd even marvel at her skills. She might be able to pirouette much faster than a football star, and be light footed, but might suck at dribbling. Very much like how we marvel at a machine's mathematical ability, but laugh as machines fall over doing things that even little kids can, such as walking across narrow beams and over different terrain in playgrounds.

If we really want to see the ballerina in her element, we'd have to go to a recital and accept that this isn't football. Most of us might fall asleep or fiddle with our phones, because we might not care for ballet, but that doesn't change the fact that the ballet dancer

is best at it. Same thing for machines. Forcing them to be like humans will never yield the right results. Next time Facebook shouldn't pull the plug, and instead should let the bots evolve...

As far as cyborgism goes, I hope we can agree that it's an attempt to be even more human than we are now. Instead of being superhumans (surpassing humans), we should perhaps look at it as us trying to be hyperhumans – humans who have enhanced their humanity by using advances in technology and science.

The goal, after all, is to be able to transfer our consciousness into a shell that can live for much longer, withstand much more physical stress, and not age and break down as much, and as quickly. Yes, the eventual goal of cyborgism, like many other things, is to try and attain immortality – and the easiest way to do that is putting a human brain into a machine.

What do you think our future holds? Write in and tell us. Just make sure to write to the Ed at editor@digit.in, because I suck at replying to emails. 📧

THE BORG KINGS AND QUEENS

People you should know about in the field of cybernetics, and what they're up to

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As you've just read Boo Man say, we're not trying to build superhumans, we're trying to build hyperhumans. The machines are just the tools that we will use to achieve hyperhuman status, and though there will always be some marketing junkie throwing the words "smart" and "AI" around for everything, when we say

smart we still mean human-like. When we say AI we think we mean "artificial" intelligence, when we actually mean "assisted" intelligence. Yes, we want tools to assist us, to think like us, to help make us better, not tools to completely replace us (as artificial intelligence would).

However, the one thing that will need to change is interfaces, if we're

ever going to embrace lives as cyborgs, and the objective of this article is to at least scratch at the surface of the changes that will need to happen in order to make that happen.

Although we don't have the space to go as in-depth as we would like to about each person or company or technology we will mention here, we hope to give you enough of a clue to